

sions. These GPUs are being used to play games and that means mobile GPUs can do some decent 3D computation as well.

4. Connect a mouse and keyboard – You can connect a mouse and a keyboard, either by using OTG cables or Bluetooth.
5. Be used as a camera – for taking pictures, videos and video-calling features.
6. Be used as a compass or a GPS receiver or as movement trackers.

If you were to perform all of this on a PC, you would typically need to connect multiple peripherals (keyboard, mouse, display, webcam, a GPS module etc.) for getting the work done.

Now let us list the components of a PC.

1. Processor
2. RAM
3. Graphics processing unit (discrete or embedded into the processor)
4. Storage devices (HDD/SSD)
5. The main board (motherboard)
6. Fans
7. Wires for connecting the components
8. Power supply unit (SMPS)

And what does a SoC contain?

1. Processor
2. RAM
3. An integrated GPU
4. Storage (Flash memory)
5. The circuitry for interconnecting the above-mentioned components (acting as the main board)

Since an SoC does not need any wires for connecting the components (they are already connected to the internal bus), a power-supply unit or fans, a SoC is almost as functional as the PC. That's not to say that SoCs don't need power at all. The power supply is external in this case and most SoCs are designed to be used in a low Thermal Design Power situation. So they don't need extra cooling which a fan provides inside a PC.

However, this is not the complete story. There are capabilities unique to each of these device classes.

Good things about the PC

One major area where a PC beats the SoC is upgradability. You can change the components of a PC and upgrade it. A better processor, more RAM, faster